Zachary Thomas

LEAD SOFTWARE ENGINEER | AI & CLOUD ARCHITECTURE

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📍 Sterling Heights, MI

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Lead Software Engineer with extensive experience architecting high-availability enterprise platforms and cloud-native microservices. Proven track record directing cross-functional engineering teams to achieve 99%+ uptime while optimizing CI/CD automation and mentoring engineers. Combines hands-on mastery in React/Next.js, Node.js, and TypeScript with ongoing graduate research in Machine Learning and AWS Infrastructure.

TECHNICAL COMPETENCIES

Leadership: Mentorship, Agile/Scrum Delivery, Architecture Governance

Languages: TypeScript, JavaScript, Python, SQL, HTML/CSS

Frontend & Backend: React, Next.js, Node.js, Express, REST/Microservices

Cloud & DevOps: AWS (CDK), CI/CD Automation, Observability & Alerting

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Compass Experience Labs
Columbus, OH

Lead Software Engineer
Dec 2024 – Present

- Lead a cross-functional team of 4 engineers delivering a high-availability Customer Service Management platform.
- Architect full-stack TypeScript solutions using React/Next.js and Node.js microservices, sustaining 99%+ uptime.
- Design scalable, version-controlled AWS cloud infrastructure using Infrastructure as Code (AWS CDK).
- Establish observability, automated alerting, and CI/CD pipelines while driving agile delivery and engineering mentorship.

Software Engineer
Jan 2024 – Dec 2024

- Engineered a real-time State Tracking System to monitor interaction metrics and surface actionable CX insights.
- Built an Intelligent Coaching Platform delivering automated real-time performance analytics for support teams.

Fleet Lab
Ann Arbor, MI

Founding Software Engineer
Apr 2023 – Sep 2023

- Spearheaded core engineering and product architecture initiatives for an early-stage transportation technology startup.

Whisker
Auburn Hills, MI

Software Engineer
Jul 2022 – Jan 2024

- Architected a centralized authentication system deployed across 10+ internal APIs, enhancing system security.
- Built an internal web application streamlining device troubleshooting workflows and lowering resolution times.

EDUCATION & LEADERSHIP

M.S. in Software Engineering (AI)
University of Michigan-Flint
Expected Dec 2028

B.S. in Software Engineering (GPA: 3.98)
University of Michigan-Flint
Dec 2024 – Dec 2027

President, NSLS (UM-Flint Chapter)
The National Society of Leadership and Success
Jan 2026 – Present

Board Member
Adam's Promise Foundation
Feb 2026 – Present